

Nitish Sainani

BACKEND HEAVY FULL STACK DEVELOPER

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Summary

Senior Software Engineer with **5+ years** of end-to-end product ownership across **fintech, mar-tech, SaaS**, and **AI-native software products**, with experience at **YC** and **Sequoia-backed startups**. Experienced in building scalable backend systems, **real-time AI assistants**, **natural language data interfaces**, and **voice intelligence services**. I **thrive** in fast-moving, cross-functional teams where clean code, data-driven decisions, and relentless optimisation drive outsized impact. Proficient in **Python, Java, Node.js, FastAPI, NestJS, Spring Boot, TypeScript, React, GraphQL, Kafka, Redis, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Elasticsearch, AWS, Docker, Kubernetes**, and **AI-first development tools** including **Cursor** and **Claude Code**.

Work Experience

Helium

Remote

SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER

June 2025 – Present

- Built **Helium**, an open-source AI data analyst platform that converts natural language business questions into SQL, helping teams get database insights faster without waiting on analysts or writing complex queries manually.
- Engineered a **safe query execution workflow** with schema-aware SQL generation, SQL preview, validation checks, and read-only database access, reducing the risk of unsafe or incorrect AI-generated queries.
- Created **explainable analysis outputs** including query explanations, structured result tables, and chart-ready responses, improving transparency and making database insights easier for business and product teams to act on.
- **Skills:** NestJS, TypeScript, Python, MySQL, PostgreSQL, SQL, React.js, API Design, Data Analytics, Open Source

Baraq

Bangalore, India

SENIOR ENGINEER

May 2023 – July 2025

- **Transaction Governance & Limits Infrastructure:** Designed and implemented a scalable limits infrastructure module for a high-volume transaction ecosystem processing thousands of transactions daily, enforcing compliance, banking, and operational rules across countries, currencies, transaction amounts, transaction frequencies, and time windows.
- **Platform Reliability & Failure Mitigation:** Redesigned error-handling architecture and optimized webhook retry mechanisms, reducing critical system failures by 40% while improving availability, fault tolerance, and service continuity.
- **Microservices & Third-Party Integration:** Integrated distributed microservices and third-party platforms across backend and internal frontend workflows, enabling secure, high-performance interoperability and strengthening the overall system architecture.
- **Skills:** NestJS, TypeScript, Java, Kafka, Redis, MySQL, AWS, Docker, React.js, JavaScript, Node.js

Bitespeed (Sequoia 2019)

Bengaluru, India

SENIOR ENGINEER

Aug 2022 – May 2023

- **Marketing Automation & Backend Architecture:** Engineered a scalable backend infrastructure to support multichannel marketing workflows, enhancing campaign orchestration capabilities and driving a 40% improvement in marketing efficiency.
- **Conversational Commerce Enablement:** Designed and deployed a WhatsApp chatbot infrastructure integrated with Shopify, enabling 100+ brands to automate customer engagement, sales conversions, and support operations at scale.
- **Platform Integration & Data Synchronization:** Built robust product synchronization pipelines and microservice workflows between Shopify, Facebook, and internal systems, reducing integration turnaround time by 60% and improving catalog accuracy across platforms.
- **Skills:** Node.js, TypeScript, Python, Java, Express.js, MongoDB, Kafka, Redis, React.js, Redux

Weekday (Y Combinator W21)

FOUNDING ENGINEER

Bengaluru, India

Nov 2021 – Sep 2022

- **Hiring Automation & Backend Engineering:** Architected backend systems and microservices using Node.js, Express.js, and Python-based services to automate end-to-end hiring funnel workflows, reducing manual intervention by 50% and streamlining recruitment operations.
- **Frontend Architecture & User Experience Optimization:** Developed a scalable React.js and Redux-based frontend framework, enhancing usability and increasing user engagement by 35% through improved interface performance and interaction design.
- **Search Performance & Data Optimization:** Implemented advanced Elasticsearch query structures, reducing candidate search latency by 90% and significantly improving system responsiveness.
- **Skills:** Node.js, Express.js, Python, FastAPI, Django, React.js, Redux, Elasticsearch, MongoDB, AWS

Morgan Stanley

SOFTWARE ENGINEER

Remote

Feb 2021 – Nov 2021

- Developed and optimized APIs for an institutional forex trade dashboard, supporting real-time trade workflows and dashboard performance improvements.
- **Skills:** Java, Spring Boot, React.js, Node.js, TypeScript, WebSockets, PostgreSQL

Skills

Full-Stack	Node.js, TypeScript, JavaScript, NestJS, Express.js, React.js, Redux, HTML, CSS, Kafka, Python, FastAPI, Django, Java, Spring Boot
Databases	MySQL, Amazon Aurora, Amazon RDS, AWS RDS, DynamoDB, Elasticsearch
AWS	AWS EC2, AWS S3, AWS Lambda, AWS Elastic Beanstalk, AWS Beanstalk, Serverless Architecture, Amazon Aurora, Amazon RDS, AWS RDS, DynamoDB, AWS SNS, AWS SQS
Core	Distributed Systems Design, System Architecture & Scalability, Event-Driven Architecture, Backend System Design, High Availability & Fault Tolerance, Performance Optimization, Observability & Monitoring, Database Design & Optimization, Message Queue Systems, API Security & Authentication
Architecture	Orchestration layer, Transaction governance, Scalable transaction governance, Limits infrastructure, High-volume remittance ecosystem, Compliance rules, Regulatory controls, Fault tolerance, Service continuity, Distributed microservice architectures, Cloud-native systems, Microservices, API design, Distributed reliability
AI	LLM, GenAI, Generative AI, AI Agents, Agentic Workflows, RAG (Retrieval-Augmented Generation), Vector Search, Embeddings, Semantic Search, Prompt Engineering, Context Engineering, MCP (Model Context Protocol), Langgraph, LangChain, LlamaIndex, OpenAI API, Claude, Cursor, scikit-learn, Prompt Engineering, Context Engineering

Education

Medicaps University

B.TECH IN COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING

India

June. 2016 - June. 2020

Relevant Projects

BucketIT

Web platform where new startups can post their product to gain early traction and initial set of users. This platform also helps founders to validate their product. Used Node.JS in backend with MongoDB and used React.JS in frontend

Redesigned Recipe

Cross Platform recipe app built with React Native. Includes all basic features with most exciting features that are suggestion of recipes through available ingredients and searching by nutritional value

E-commerce App

Cross platform e-commerce application built in React Native